

and it ultimately advances to par, he has gained \$40 per share.

And suppose he sells on any given day at par, and a week after that the shares sell at 110, he then loses \$10 per share. So that this "safe" road to success has its stumbling blocks as well as others, although they are not so dangerous. In such a road there are no deadly pitfalls. The men who travel it are not tempted to defalcations and suicides.

People have preconceived notions. They are not willing to clear their minds of existing theories and bring themselves down to close dealing with facts.

Horace Greeley once said that the way to resume specie payments was to resume; and it might also be said that the way to study the stock market is to study it. One distinguished and generally-successful stock operator of the period is credited with being in daily receipt of numerous pieces of information from various parts of the country as to the condition of crops, weather, freights, passenger traffic, in short, all facts that go to make up the status of railroad enterprises. These private bits of information are not open to the general public—they cost too much, and call for too much machinery; but the bureaus of public information are continually sending out intelligence, and it is mostly trustworthy. This class of facts must be distinguished from mere rumors.

Rumor is, as a rule, uncertain and untrustworthy. It has been compared to an animated thing that begins its career by being small and compact, but as it stalks along it becomes larger and less definite as to form, until at last it is like a monstrous cloud that has neither shape nor consistency, and finally disappears, no one knows how or where. But to study facts leads to generally accurate conclusions; and accurate conclusions are apt to lead to wise transactions.